PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Toyota Land Cruiser 300 Series

2021–present · VJA300 · FJA300 · GRJ300

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Accept that it's an LX in the US**
  The 300 isn't sold in the US or Canada and can't be legally imported under the 25-year rule for a long time. For North American buyers, the LX 600 or LX 700h is the 300 Series you can actually buy.

- [ ] **Run the VIN against the V35A recalls**
  NHTSA campaigns 24V381 and 25V767 cover V35A engines in which machining debris can damage the main bearings, causing knocking, rough running, a no-start or a stall. 25V767 lists 9,895 2022–2024 LX models built from 26 February 2022 to 2 April 2024; 24V381 covered earlier engines. Ask whether the engine has already been replaced, which several IH8MUD members' trucks have had.

- [ ] **Check the transmission software recall**
  NHTSA 26V094000 (Lexus 26LA01) covers about 4,400 2025–26 LX 600s: if a transmission solenoid fails, the transmission and engine ECUs can lose communication and the transmission can damage itself. Dealers update the transmission ECU software for free. In Australia, Toyota recalled 11,020 300s built from February to December 2025 for the same kind of fault. A failed solenoid can let the transmission over-rev, damaging it or leaking fluid onto the hot exhaust; dealers reprogram the transmission ECU (CarExpert, February 2026).

- [ ] **Test-drive in traffic, not just on the highway**
  Owners of 2022–24 LX 600s describe a clunk into first gear and hesitation when accelerating from a rolling stop. Some blame the pre-collision system intervening. Drive one through a few stop-and-go junctions before you buy. Owners say the LX 700h hybrid doesn't do it.

- [ ] **Work the rear hatch**
  One IH8MUD owner's power hatch beeped and refused to close. The cause was a sticking left-side pinch sensor, which was replaced. Open and close it several times.

- [ ] **AHC or not, and which locker count?**
  Many LX trims have height-adjustable AHC suspension, and armor is specific to it: Slee sells separate non-AHC LX 600 sliders, for example. Overtrail and GR Sport trucks have front and rear lockers; standard trucks have only the center lock. Know which one you're buying.

- [ ] **Ask about fluid changes**
  Owners on IH8MUD do early differential and transfer-case changes (around 20,000–30,000 miles) after reports of debris in Tundra differential oil. Records of early oil and gear-oil changes, or oil-analysis reports, are a good sign.

- [ ] **Diesel: how was it driven?**
  Ask whether a diesel 300 lived in town or towed heavy. Short trips are hard on the DPF and EGR, and heat soak from heavy towing or sand work is linked to bearing wear (Unsealed 4X4). Check the oil level, ask how much it uses between services, and confirm software updates and recall work are done. Look at the fuel-filter area for damage or a guard.

YEARS TO KNOW

2021–24	RECALL	Early Australian trucks are covered by recalls XGG22 (stability control may not default to on; built 16 July 2021 to 1 April 2022) and ZGG04 (10-speed can creep in neutral; built 16 July 2021 to 12 January 2024). Both are software fixes, so check they have been done

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- ☐ **10-speed transmission can over-rev (Australia)**
  Built Feb–Dec 2025 · Toyota Australia recall, Feb 2026
- ☐ **Can creep forward in neutral (Australia)**
  Built Jul 2021–Jan 2024 · Toyota Australia recall, Feb 2024
- ☐ **Stability control may not default to on (Australia)**
  Built Mar 2021–Apr 2022 · Toyota Australia recall, Apr 2022

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- ☐ **Model codes**
  VJA300 = 3.4 V35A-FTS twin-turbo petrol V6. FJA300 = 3.3 F33A-FTV twin-turbo diesel V6. GRJ300 = 4.0 1GR-FE V6 with a 6-speed automatic. VJH300 = V35A hybrid.
- ☐ **GR Sport lockers**
  The GR Sport has front and rear diff locks. Standard 300s lock only the centre diff, so check the switches if lockers matter to you.
- ☐ **US sibling**
  The Lexus LX 600 / LX 700h (J310) is the 300's US-market twin, on the same frame and powertrains. It's the only legal way to own this platform new in the US.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/land-cruiser/300-series/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks